CLASSROOM INVESTIGATIONS / TEACHER HANDBOOK

Evidence to Action

A teacher's guide to evaluating AI-supported claims

Four practical investigations in evidence, uncertainty and responsible decisions.

FOR

Grades 6-8

SEQUENCE

4 x 45 min

START WITH

8-min baseline

01 / FRAME

State the claim.
Keep your first view.

02 / INVESTIGATE

Inspect original records.
Name what is missing.

03 / DECIDE

Choose an action.
Explain what changed.

Paper-first. No live AI or student accounts required.

Fictional cases and prepared replies. Classroom pilot for educator review; not a validated assessment or a claim of school approval.

01 / PROGRAMME BRIEF

Teach the reasoning behind the recommendation.

The goal is a supported decision a learner can explain, rather than a polished answer they cannot defend.

Learning objective	Look for this in the learner's work
Connect claims to sources	An exact detail from an original record, with a statement of what it supports.
Recognise uncertainty	A specific limit involving the measure, comparison, sample or duration.
Choose proportionate action	A feasible next check, justified pause or conditional recommendation.
Retain responsibility	A reason for the help chosen, a meaningful revision and a person responsible.

Use this as a complete paper pathway

Print the learner pages, provide pencils, and use a board for the shared discussion. A projector and the Vizancia app are optional. The supplied AI-style replies are fixed authored examples, not outputs generated from students' instructions.

What this edition includes

Teacher notes and worked examples: T01-T10. Learner handouts in the complete packet or separate student PDF: S00-S08. Stable page codes connect the versions. Keep teacher keys away from first attempts.

> **Print only what you need**
>
> Baseline: S00. Session 1: S01-S02. Session 2: S03-S04 plus S01. Session 3: S05-S06 plus S01. Session 4: S07-S08. Keep the garden evidence for sessions 2 and 3.

02 / LEARNING SEQUENCE

Build the routine. Then test it in a new setting.

Four sessions, each with one clear student output. Allow about eight additional minutes for the baseline before session 1.

Session	Central question	Evidence of learning
01 / Check the claim	What can this small test support?	A qualified headline or a justified request for a better test.
02 / Verify the reply	What improved, and what is still unsupported?	A checked recommendation with the invented price removed.
03 / Make the decision	Whose needs, approval and safeguards matter?	A recommendation with an owner, conditions and a review or stop rule.
04 / Apply independently	Can I use the routine without copying the earlier answer?	An individual first response, then a clearly separated supported revision.

A consistent 45-minute rhythm

5 minutes: think first. 8 minutes: inspect the evidence. 12 minutes: examine or apply. 12 minutes: recommend or discuss. 8 minutes: explain and reflect. Each session plan specifies the activity within that structure.

> **Protect the final independent attempt**
>
> Do not reveal the quiet-desk solution, hints about the measurement error or worked responses until S08's first response has been preserved. Keep agreed access supports; record any extra content help.

03 / FACILITATION PROTOCOL

Make thinking visible before offering help.

Use the same expectations for oral, written, drawn or scribed explanations.

Before the sequence	During every session
Read the cases, keys and answer-release order. Confirm local approval, accessibility and device rules.	Ask for an initial view. Withhold the worked answer. Ask learners to point to the detail supporting their claim.
Print selected pages. Plan pairs or groups of three. A reader, checker and reporter can rotate.	Let students distinguish observation, interpretation and uncertainty. Accept a justified no-AI route.
Complete S00 individually before substantive teaching. Keep identified work within the school.	Use prepared replies only. Do not require a live service, account, student name, photo or private disclosure.

A brief for useful help

Ask learners to state the task, audience, sources, constraints and kind of help before inspecting the prepared replies. A helpful instruction can improve organisation; it cannot make an unsupported detail true.

A repeatable record

My first view -> help I chose -> independent check -> decision -> revision. Ask what the learner found, what it changed and why. A second AI-style reply alone is not an independent check.

> **Access support is not an answer**
>
> Read aloud, enlarge print, allow oral answers and use a scribe or familiar assistive tool. Do not assess spelling, handwriting, speed, confidence or willingness to disclose personal experiences. Keep access support distinct from substantive hints.

04 / SESSION 1 FACILITATOR PLAN

A small test does not establish a universal claim.

45 minutes / S01-S02; preserve S01

Teach the distinction

A claim is a statement to evaluate. A source is a record to inspect. Evidence is the relevant detail in that record. A recommendation connects the evidence to a decision.

Minutes	Teacher move	Learner task
0-5	Think first	Read the claim aloud; record a first view on S02 before showing the records.
5-13	Inspect	Read the three records. Clarify unfamiliar words without supplying the conclusion.
13-25	Trace	In pairs, connect each claim to a record. Does the poster add a new test?
25-37	Recommend	Write a headline that stays within the evidence, or explain why more testing is needed.
37-45	Explain	Name a source, a limit and a useful next check. Record what changed.

> **A responsible headline**
>
> "Small two-day garden test used 10 rather than 20 litres; plant health and results in other conditions remain untested." This preserves the observation without endorsing a universal claim.

Coach the reasoning

Which record measured that, and which conditions would your headline need to retain?

05 / SESSION 2 FACILITATOR PLAN

A clearer reply still needs a source check.

45 minutes / S03-S04 plus S01

Teach the distinction

A prompt is an instruction, not a guarantee. A reply can be well organised and still contain an invented detail. Verify each factual sentence against an original record.

Minutes	Teacher move	Learner task
0-5	Set criteria	Write what a responsible recommendation must include. Choose a kind of help.
5-13	Compare	Read S03 alongside S01. Both replies are authored simulations.
13-25	Verify	Check each factual sentence. Use the source inventory to test the price claim.
25-37	Revise	Remove unsupported content. Write a checked recommendation and a more precise brief.
37-45	Explain	Identify the edit, the source behind it and what remains unresolved.

> **A source-driven correction**
>
> "The records do not establish a price, so I removed the 30-credit claim. I kept the small-test result and would request verified costs before a purchase decision." Unknown is not the same as zero.

Coach the reasoning

Which sentence did you check, what did the source establish, and what did you change?

06 / SESSION 3 FACILITATOR PLAN

A responsible decision needs conditions and an owner.

45 minutes / S05-S06 plus S01

Teach the distinction

Evidence describes what is supported; values describe what matters. A vote does not establish that a system works. A proposal does not authorise a purchase or a trial.

Minutes	Teacher move	Learner task
0-5	Take a view	Name affected people and record the initial recommendation on S06.
5-13	Inspect roles	Read S05. Separate a reported need, a preference and a fact to verify.
13-25	Deliberate	Rotate reader, checker and reporter. Paraphrase one disagreement fairly.
25-37	Specify	Write the conditions, owner, approval and review or stop rule.
37-45	Reflect	Explain how a perspective changed the recommendation or why it was retained.

> **A conditional recommendation**
>
> "Consider a supervised trial only after approval, a verified cost and an accessible alternative are agreed. Name an adult to monitor plant health, compare with a simpler timer and pause if the agreed safeguards fail." Waiting can also be justified.

Coach the reasoning

What would make your group pause or stop, and who has authority to decide?

07 / SESSION 4 FACILITATOR PLAN

Independent transfer comes before coached revision.

45 minutes / S07-S08; preserve first response

Preserve the independent attempt

Give S07 and S08 before discussing the new case. Remind learners of the routine without pointing out the error. Preserve the first response before feedback or substantive hints.

Minutes	Teacher move	Learner task
0-5	Think first	Introduce the claim without diagnosing it. Record the initial view.
5-13	Inspect	Read S07 individually, with agreed accessibility support.
13-25	Apply alone	Complete the first S08 recommendation before feedback. Collect or preserve it.
25-37	Discuss	Only now compare reasoning and reveal the case key. Mark any support used.
37-45	Revise	Use the separate revision area to explain a meaningful change or justified recheck.

Reveal only after the first response

The trial counted pages, not comprehension. Different groups, materials and noise levels weaken the comparison. Unnamed websites add no traceable evidence. A fair next check must measure understanding and retain accessible alternatives.

Coach the reasoning

After preserving the first response: what was measured, and what did the claim promise?

08 / ASSESSMENT AND FEEDBACK

Assess the explanation, not agreement with an option.

Use the original informal rubric for the baseline and the first session-4 response. Keep supported revisions separate.

Dimension	0 / Not yet shown	1 / Partial	2 / Explained
Evidence	No relevant detail or an unsupported claim.	Names a relevant source detail.	Explains what it supports; separates repetition from independent support.
Limits	Accepts or rejects without a reason.	Names a relevant uncertainty.	Explains how the measure, comparison, sample or duration limits the claim.
Next action	No useful next step.	Suggests a relevant check.	Specifies a feasible check and links it to the decision or affected people.
Help and responsibility	No reason for the help chosen.	Gives a relevant reason.	Connects help to verification, permission or learning; retains human responsibility.

Use the result descriptively

Each dimension is 0-2; a total of 0-8 describes this task. It is not a certification, a validated scale or a grade of a person. Missing work is missing, not zero. Multiple actions can be defensible when the reasoning is supported.

> **Do not infer a programme effect**
>
> Baseline and transfer cases are related, not equivalent standardised tests. Practice, teaching, attendance, task differences and support can affect responses. Use these scores only for this activity; do not combine them with a different rubric or claim a causal gain.

09 / WORKED EXAMPLES

Locate one reasoning gap. Coach one meaningful revision.

Teacher reference only. Use these examples after the relevant first attempt.

SESSION 1 / A CLAIM, A SOURCE AND A CONCLUSION ARE DIFFERENT THINGS

Illustrative learner response	What to notice / next prompt
It saves half the water, so we should buy it.	The result has lost its conditions. Ask: which words would keep the claim limited to this test?
The small test used 10 instead of 20 litres. I would report that result but ask about plant health before recommending a purchase.	The observation is bounded and linked to a next check. Ask: why does plant health matter to this decision?

SESSION 2 / A USEFUL PROMPT IS A BRIEF, NOT A GUARANTEE

Illustrative learner response	What to notice / next prompt
I added more detail to my prompt, so the answer is reliable now.	A longer prompt is being treated as proof. Ask: which factual sentence did you verify against a source?
I removed the 30-credit price because the original folder does not verify it. My new brief asks the help to label unsupported details as unknown.	The correction follows a source check. Ask: how will you verify the next version?

Review cycle

Locate the source connection. Name one gap. Ask a focused question. Let the learner revise or justify retaining the answer. Recheck the change. A longer or smoother answer alone is not evidence of stronger understanding.

10 / REVIEW AND RESOURCES

Keep useful evidence. Choose the next teaching step.

A brief local review helps distinguish a usable lesson from a claim about impact.

Review question	Record locally
Did the sequence run as planned?	Actual teaching time; selected route; access supports; interruptions or additional help.
Where did reasoning break down?	Aggregate patterns: source connection, limits, next check, or responsibility. Keep missing responses separate.
What should happen next?	Reteach one distinction, use another fictional claim, or plan a locally approved extension.
What may be shared?	Only non-identifying material feedback or safe aggregate observations. Never send student work, names or private reflections.

Use the projection as an optional aid

vizancia.com/teachers/activity/ provides the original four-case projection. It retains its earlier case title. Use paper for individual responses; keep facilitator notes and model answers off screen until students give reasons. An app or live AI service is not needed.

Further educator reading

UNESCO, AI competency framework for students (2024). NIST AI 600-1, Generative AI Profile (2024). These support background reading, not an endorsement or validation of this programme.

UNESCO: unesco.org/en/articles/ai-competency-framework-students
NIST: doi.org/10.6028/NIST.AI.600-1

Fictional learning cases. Classroom copying permitted; no resale or implied endorsement. Educator-review pilot, not field-tested or validated.

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